

Monday, 8 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Rain

18° 13°

BIRMINGHAM

Light rain

15° 11°

MANCHESTER

Light rain

16° 11°

GLASGOW

Drizzle

15° 10°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 Sikh MPs say Nowak murder was not about their religion.**
11 Sikh MPs say the killing was about "a man carrying an offensive weapon and committing a brutal murder".
UK · NEWS
- 2 'My great-grandad saved your life' - Aberfan survivor left stunned on school visit.**
An Aberfan disaster survivor met the great-grandson of the caretaker who pulled him from the rubble.
UK · NEWS
- 3 Delays to defence plan undermine UK credibility, MPs say.**
The Defence Investment Plan is now due to be released ahead of a Nato summit early next month.
UK · NEWS

02 – SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1

US actor James Handy stabbed to death, with girlfriend's son arrested.

Handy, 81, is known for his roles in films including Jumanji and Top Gun: Maverick.

SHOWBIZ · UK

2

'Rik Mayall was extraordinary': Festival held in comic's memory.

Actor Nigel Planer fondly remembers his time working on The Young Ones with co-star Rik Mayall.

SHOWBIZ · UK

3

The Amazing Digital Circus: Another YouTube sensation hits cinemas.

The Amazing Digital Circus is being shown in cinemas after fans emailed chains asking them to show it.

SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

1

Highlights: Romania 2-1 Wales.

Watch the best of the action as Romania defeat Wales 2-1 in Bucharest.

SPORT · UK

2

Lord's pitch does not benefit Test format - Stokes.

England captain Ben Stokes says the Lord's pitch on which his side won the first Test against New Zealand is not helpful for the future of the game's longest format.

SPORT · UK

3

Atkinson finishes with five as England beat NZ to win opening Test.

Gus Atkinson stars on day four as England bowl out New Zealand in the morning session, taking five wickets to secure a 115-run victory at Lord's and go 1-0 up in the three-match series.

SPORT · UK

4

Born in Leeds, crafted in Norway: How Haaland became nation's superstar.

Erling Haaland has guided Norway to their first World Cup since 1998. So what is it like being a global name from a nation with a population of just 5.5m people?

SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The average Brit checks their phone 159 times a day — but says it 'doesn't feel like that much'.**
Researchers using passive monitoring apps say we badly underestimate our own usage. Most people guess between 30 and 70 times.
- 2 62% of us have lied about reading a book to look smart in front of someone we fancy.**
Most-faked titles: 1984, Pride and Prejudice and (awkwardly) the Bible. One in five admit to faking a whole dinner-party conversation about a novel they'd only seen the cover of.
- 3 British baby names are getting shorter again — three- and four-letter names are dominating the registrar.**
Top picks this year: Noa, Ezra, Ada and Bo. Long, multi-syllable Victorian names like Theodora are sliding back down the chart.
- 4 Three quarters of dog owners now talk to their dog more than they talk to their partner.**
Top topics: 'what we're doing later', 'what we just saw out the window' and a surprising amount of Bake Off commentary. 12% admit they've apologised to the dog after a row with the human.
- 5 Almost 70% of UK households now have a smart speaker — but the most common use is still 'asking what time it is'.**
Researchers say we under-use the devices we own. Setting timers, playing music and weather queries make up two thirds of all commands.
- 6 Pubs report a Tuesday boom — the new 'mid-week meet' is the fastest-growing dining occasion.**
Operators say WFH-ers like getting out the house mid-week without the weekend crowds. Tuesday wine sales are up almost 30%.
- 7 Roses are out, peonies are in — UK florists report a 200% rise in peony orders for weddings this summer.**
Brides cite 'softer, less staged' aesthetics. Wholesale peony prices have crept up accordingly.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 71% of us admit to doing **THIS** in the car when we think no-one is watching. What is it?
ANSWER: SINGING AT THE TOP OF OUR LUNGS, WITH FULL DRAMATIC FACIAL EXPRESSIONS.

Q Asked 'what's the most British thing about your morning?', the number one answer wasn't a cup of tea — it was **THIS**.
ANSWER: APOLOGISING TO SOMEONE WHO WALKED INTO YOU.

TALK TOPIC

- **A survey says 30% of us have a 'forever favourite' meal we'd be happy eating every day.**
Talk-back: what's yours? And could you really eat it every day?
- **Researchers say the average person has 27 unread voicemails. We're voicemail-phobic.**
Talk-back: when did you last actually listen to one? And who left it?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A goldfish at Bristol Aquarium has been confirmed as the oldest in captivity in the UK after celebrating its 23rd birthday last week. Staff say its secret is a 'strict diet and very calm music'.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A Scottish brewery has begun training rescue dogs to detect over-fermented kegs by scent, with the lead beagle reportedly never wrong in six months.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A cloud can weigh more than a million pounds — about the same as 100 elephants. They float because they're spread across miles of sky.
- Honey never spoils. Edible honey has been found in 3,000-year-old Egyptian tombs.
- Octopuses have three hearts and blue blood. Two pump blood through the gills, the third pumps it round the body.
- The Eiffel Tower can grow up to 15cm taller in summer because the iron expands in the heat.
- The dot above a lowercase 'i' or 'j' has a name — it's called a tittle.
- Bananas are technically berries. Strawberries, somehow, are not.
- Wombats produce cube-shaped poo. Scientists worked out it's the elasticity of their intestines.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time — 1/100th of a second. So 'back in a jiffy' is the fastest promise you can make.

On this day

Day 159 of the year, 206 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Chlodulf of Metz; Christian feast day: Jacques Berthieu, S.J.; Christian feast day: Jadwiga (Hedwig) of Poland; Christian feast day: Mariam Thresia Chiramel. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1966 — Julianna Margulies, American actress
- 1937 — Gillian Clarke, Welsh poet and playwright
- 1936 — James Darren, American actor (died 2024)
- 1951 — Bonnie Tyler, Welsh singer-songwriter
- 1945 — Steven Fromholz, American singer-songwriter, producer, and poet (died 2014)
- 1977 — Kanye West, American rapper, producer, director, and fashion designer
- 1965 — Kevin Farley, American screenwriter
- 1950 — Kathy Baker, American actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 2007 — Space Shuttle Atlantis is launched on STS-117 carrying two truss segments and solar arrays to the International Space Station.
- 1968 — James Earl Ray, the man who assassinated Martin Luther King Jr. is arrested at London Heathrow Airport.
- 1995 — Downed U.S. Air Force pilot Captain Scott O'Grady is rescued by U.S. Marines in Bosnia.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1953 — An F5 tornado hits Beecher, Michigan, United States, killing 116, injuring 844, and destroying 340 homes.
- 1972 — Vietnam War: Nine-year-old Phan Thị Kim Phúc is burned by napalm, an event captured by Associated Press photographer Nick Ut moments later while the young girl is seen running naked down a road, in what would become an iconic, Pulitzer Prize-winning photo.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1982 — Bluff Cove Air Attacks during the Falklands War: Fifty-six British servicemen are killed by an Argentine air attack on two landing ships, RFA Sir Galahad and RFA Sir Tristram.

- 1961 — Marriage of Prince Edward, Duke of Kent to Katharine Worsley at York Minster.
- 1995 — Downed U.S. Air Force pilot Captain Scott O'Grady is rescued by U.S. Marines in Bosnia.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 160 of the year, 205 days left in 2026. Today Anniversary of the Accession of King Abdullah II (Jordan); Autonomy Day (Åland); Christian feast day: Aidan of Lindisfarne (Evangelical Lutheran Church in America); Christian feast day: Blessed Anna Maria Taigi. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1912 — Ingolf Dahl, German-American pianist, composer, and conductor (died 1970)
- 1954 — Pete Byrne, English singer-songwriter
- 1926 — Calvin "Fuzz" Jones, American singer and bass player (died 2010)
- 1915 — Les Paul, American guitarist and songwriter (died 2009)
- 1961 — Aaron Sorkin, American screenwriter, producer, and playwright
- 1977 — Usman Afzaal, Pakistani-English cricketer
- 1953 — Ken Navarro, Italian-American guitarist and composer
- 1988 — Mae Whitman, American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1928 — Charles Kingsford Smith completes the first trans-Pacific flight in a Fokker Trimotor monoplane, the Southern Cross.
- 1965 — Vietnam War: The Viet Cong commences combat with the Army of the Republic of Vietnam in the Battle of Đồng Xoài, one of the largest battles in the war.
- 2008 — Two bombs explode at a train station near Algiers, Algeria, killing at least 13 people.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1965 — Vietnam War: The Viet Cong commences combat with the Army of the Republic of Vietnam in the Battle of Đồng Xoài, one of the largest battles in the war.
- 1954 — Joseph N. Welch, special counsel for the United States Army, lashes out at Senator Joseph McCarthy during the Army-McCarthy hearings, giving McCarthy the famous rebuke, "You've done enough. Have you no sense of decency, sir, at long last? Have you left no sense of decency?"

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)